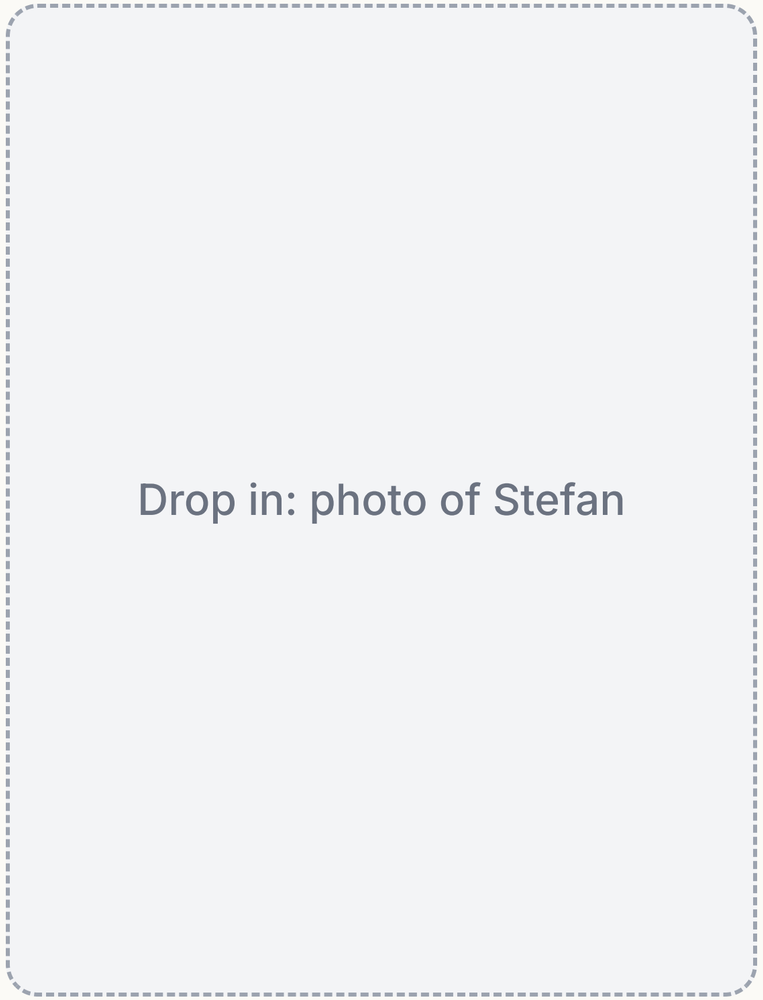
BUILT YOUNG, DESIGN PHASE

Lesson 1: From idea to wireframes.



Today your plan starts turning into screens you can click through.

Hi, I'm Stefan



What I do

I'm a product designer. I take apps from idea to launch, the same path you're on now.

Fun fact

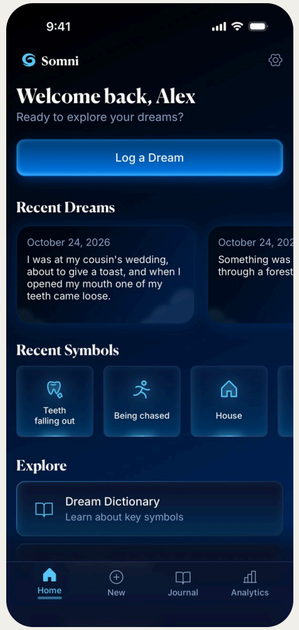
Before design, I fought wildfires.

Why I love design

I love building things, and design is the heart of building anything.

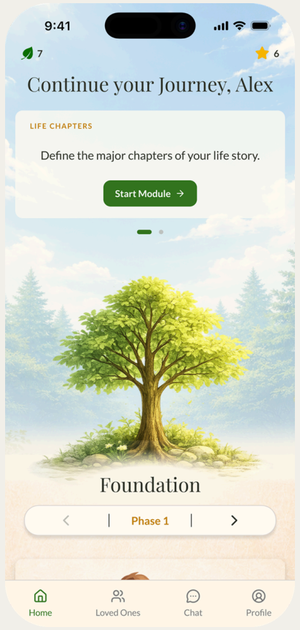
Some things I've made

I also helped Netflix's product team learn to use AI in their design process.



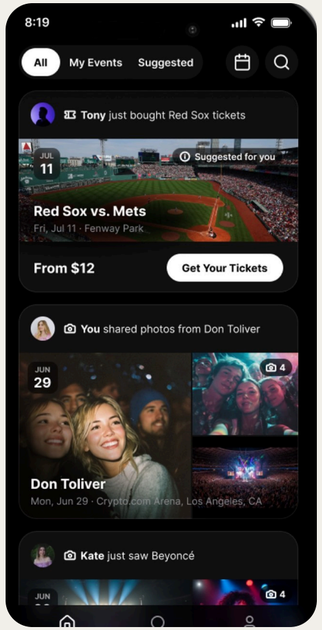
Somni

A dream journal app.



LastingMind

An AI app that helps you save your life stories.

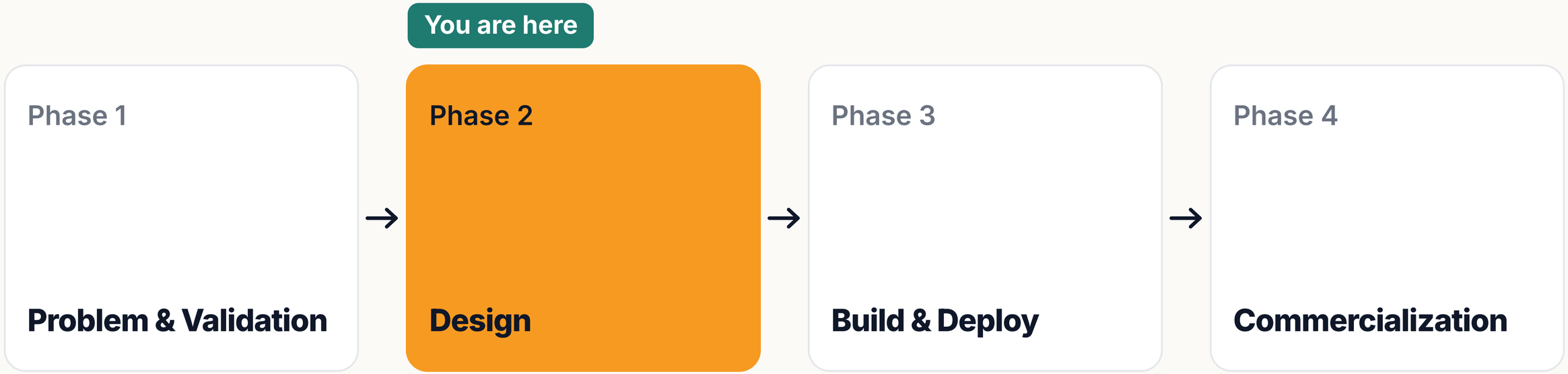


FanFeed

Relive the shows and events you've been to.

Where we are

Built Young has four phases.



Course goals

1

Learn the design process

so you can repeat it on any project.

2

Learn to think like a designer

The course in three parts

Lessons 1 and 2

Make it work

Good UX: wireframes, then testing with real people.

Lesson 3

Make it look good

Art direction, a design system and hi-fi screens.

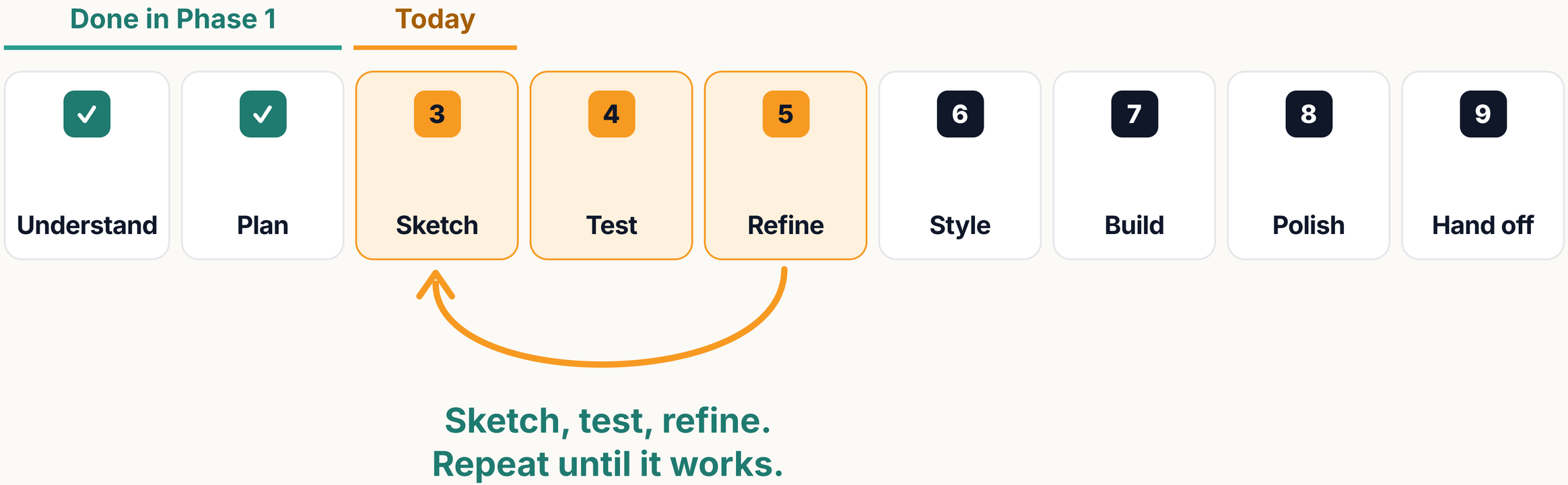
Lessons 4 and 5

Make it feel premium

Building in Claude Code, then polish, motion and the handoff to your engineer.

The design process

Nine steps you can use on any project.



What makes a good designer

1. **Start with people**
   Design for how people really think and act, not for yourself.

2. **Solve the right problem**
   Find what actually needs to get better before you design.

3. **Use design judgment**
   Decide what to build, what to cut, and when it's done.

4. **Sweat the craft**
   Get the details right so people feel confident using it.

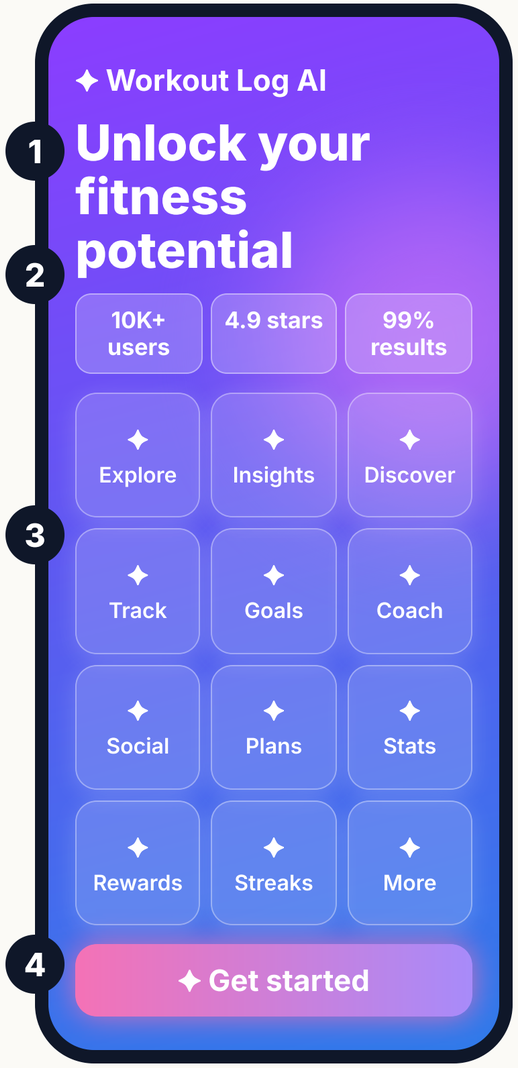
5. **Test and learn**
   Let what you see change your mind.

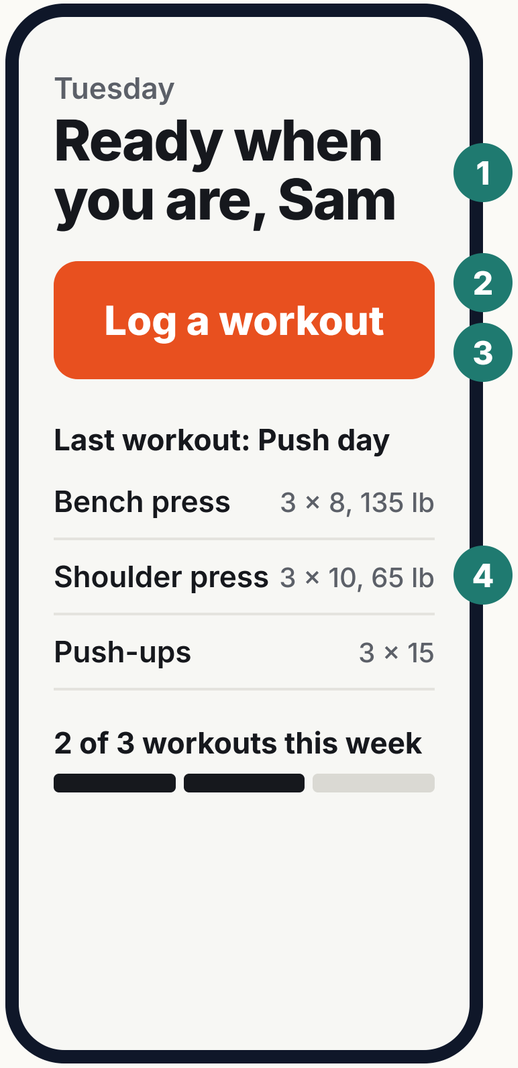
6. **Explain your thinking**
   Make your choices clear so others can understand them and decide with you.

AI slop vs designed

AI slop

1. Hype words that say nothing
2. Fake stats
3. A dozen buttons that all look the same
4. Purple gradients, glass and sparkles





Designed

1. Clear hierarchy: big, then small
2. One clear next step
3. One accent color
4. Real workout content

How to spot AI slop

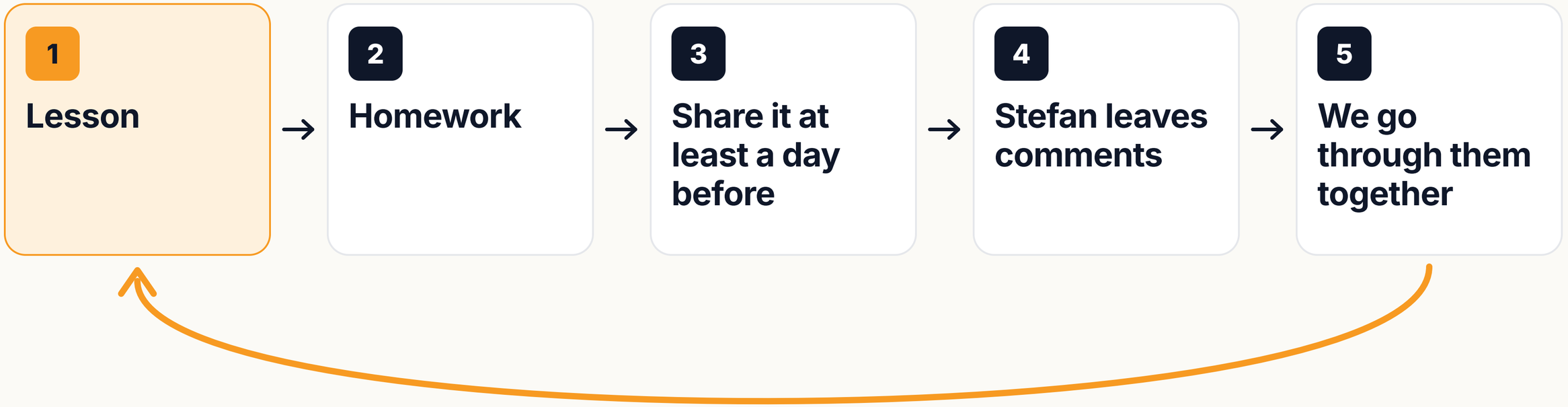
- It looks like every other app
- Hype words that say nothing
- Too many features on one screen
- Fake people, stats or reviews
- Effects instead of ideas

AI is the producer.

You're the director.

How this course works

Every lesson runs on the same loop.



Today's objectives

By the end of today, you can...

- Name the steps of the design process
- Say who your users are and what your core loop is
- Explain why Epic 1 comes first and where the MVP cut line is
- Judge a screen with 9 good UX rules
- Start wireframing in Claude Design

Today's principles

Principle 1

Start with people

Design for how people really think and act, not for yourself.

Ask yourself

Who is this for, and what are they trying to do?

Principle 2

Solve the right problem

Find what actually needs to get better before you design.

Ask yourself

What's the one thing this app has to do well?

Example: the Workout Log epic map

Epic 1	**Log a workout**	The core loop
Epic 2	**Get started**	
Epic 3	**See your progress**	

MVP cut line

Epic 4	Share with friends	Later

Notice: the core loop comes first. Everything below the line waits.

Good UX in 9 rules

Good UX means people can use your app without help.

1. **Obvious next step**
2. **Speaks the user's language**
3. **Shows what's happening**
4. **Easy to undo**
5. **Prevents mistakes, and helps fix them**
6. **Consistent and familiar**
7. **Shows, doesn't make you remember**
8. **Only what's needed**
9. **Works for everyone**

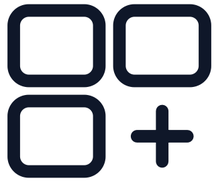
Try it

Drop in: real app screen

Find one rule it follows and one it breaks.

Use the 9 good UX rules. There's no wrong answer if you can say why.

What you'll make today



Part one

Your Claude Design project



Part two

The first screens of your core loop